

Transcript of AI-driven Cash Recovery

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Amount of cash today, any viable issue that I need to solve it today in order to not, let's say, get into another type of burning platform tomorrow.

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That's nice, but if I constantly need to be the firefighter looking only at the actuals, trying to, let's say, pick up sales order information, purchase order information that's basically the left-hand side of your screen, that's nice.

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But actually, if we really want to think about this topic in a more tactical and strategic way, then we need to also look into, okay, well, where are my investments going?

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Where are my operating results?

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Do I expect inflationary expenses?

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What's—what about hyperinflation in some—in some countries, etc., etc.?

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Can I predict what is coming on the longer term, right?

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And then, let's say, in order to get that complete, make sure that I also have to include external signals, external information, looking outside instead of only inside my little UV box or inside my operational environment.

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And that's basically the real one—the first scenario that I want to dive into.

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Where we're going to have to look at three personas: the CFO, the resales manager, and the supplier manager.

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This flow I'm not going to walk you through across.

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It's just, let's say, afterwards you might be able, uh, to—to look into the—into the information, uh, once more, and so you know, let's say, you can remember the—the guidance.

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But we're going to do, actually, is immediately jump into, uh, into our CFO.

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The CFO is logging onto her system, uh, in the morning, getting immediate, uh, you know, alerts, um, let's say, and this is—this is real, right?

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This is something which works today.

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Because there's something wrong with my cash situation.

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My—my—um, my cash conversion cycle is going down.

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So really what I want to do is understand where this is coming from.

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And of course, for some of us very finance and figure literate, we can analyze all these charts and graphs, etc., etc., but that doesn't mean that we always really know and can pinpoint what's going wrong, right?

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So what we want to do is really get that pulled out for us.

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If you think about not you as a CFO, but you as the, the, the business unit manager, they might not need us figure literates because they don't have a finance background.

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But think about it.

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They also need to take care that their business unit is working fine and running, um, let's say, correctly.

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So, like, where is my problem?

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And—and of course you already see, let's say, in this set of charts, probably some of you already see that on the bottom left-hand side, my base order spending is rising.

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Uh, so yeah, I might have an issue there, um, which, let's say, which is, of course, something we need to take care of.

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My BPO seems to be under control for now.

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Uh, my investment plan potential, actually, I didn't even mention here because I would—it would take us a little bit too far.

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But imagine that all these typical analysis tests that we're doing ourselves on a regular basis, that it's automatically done in the background by, um, agents, AI agents, as we might be, uh, call it, just basically by automating all of that so that we can really concentrate on the exceptions.

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We don't have to analyze, but we can take that action to create that value that somebody was, uh, talking about, let's say, earlier on.

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And that's all happening here on the right-hand side, right?

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Using, uh, our digital assistant, Joe, who you definitely have heard about it.

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I just sometimes wonder how much of this you have already seen.

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This is basically, uh, real Joe, basically saying, "Well, my BSO is something changed on social media." Of course, this is an oversimplification of the real world, right?

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That's—that's for sure.

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So basically, by just interacting, and I can do voice controls with my primary typing, I want to look at, you know, okay, what is the contextual information?

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Because it's not only about the hard figures.

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It's really understanding what situation I'm in.

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What is the state of my purchase orders?

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What is the status of my sales orders?

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How sure am I that they're not going to be canceled, uh, as if it's really having impact on what I see here?

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But of course, as a CFO, I don't, let's say, tend to do all the work myself.

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Like, I don't have the time for that.

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So basically, I want to engage with my receivables there.

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So, let's say, using our language, calling about this special, in my opinion, let's say, I'm handing this now over.

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So that messaging is auto-generated.

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I don't have to type anything.

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And of course, as a consequence, now I'm jumping into the role of my receivables agent, uh, manager, basically.

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His game, then I pitch, "Come on, pay me." Uh, Elon, I think he was his name in our demo scenario.

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"Please take care of this." First thing he does is basically, again, ask Joe, "Look into what's the problem?"

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Where can I get guidance?

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What is the real issue?" And like long story short, basically, I'm leading straight into my receivables, my overviews.

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And it seems to be that, like, I don't really have a two-string problem of 120 days plus of customers, uh, that are sending that are not being paid.

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It's really on the short term.

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And I have in this particular case, especially one customer that I want to look into.

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So of course, then I need to know where to go.

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Like in the past, we had our transaction codes.

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If you are, which is already a market for 10 years, let's say, well, we have our tiles, but we still have to look at where do I need to go, right?

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Up till now, I've not ever had to ask a question like, "Where am I going?" I'm getting guided by the system to the place where I should go, okay?

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This is just one example.

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I want to pinpoint it out here.

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So I'm just going to open up my process to, like, process my receivables.

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Is that something new?

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No, not really.

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Just then the details, the payment trends, all of my—all of my data at my fingertips to understand what I should do, not where to find the right information, etc., etc.

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We've come a long way for that, right?

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And because actually, um, I do seem to have a short-term issue, uh, in terms of my liquidity, I need to get this solved now.

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That's the firefighting thing I was talking about before.

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Um, of course, that's not ideal for conservative cases.

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Yeah. You might have to.

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How can I get the rip-off cash?

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How can I get that cash in?

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Well, one of the options is basically to factory out.

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And of course, you have all third parties for that.

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But these days, we can also do that using software.

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There's all the apps, the so-called all-app solution, which actually is doing this for me.

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So basically, I'm pushing out through a third party, um, my open items.

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I'm basically getting this prepaid crypto, like it's a network solution.

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I'm basically requesting my early payment, etc., etc.

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Um, and I go on, right?

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I don't jump between systems.

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I just go with the flow.

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I see what the options are, etc., etc.

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Another element, of course, in the meantime, I hope this isn't working.

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Videos can also crash.

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No, no, they're crashing.

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Okay, good.

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So basically, the next thing is, well, you know, I've got that issue covered.

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Now I want to understand, you say, well, there's payments coming in.

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In the AMEC on that side, we already had an AI capability since 2016 by Race.

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It's old, not so new, which we call the Cash App.

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Um, but it was very stringent in terms of how I can adjust the rule setting because it wasn't really black box.

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So in the meantime, we've been opening all of these AI capabilities, opening those black boxes to allow you to really understand what's happening, uh, behind the scenes.

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Because that might also have an impact on how, let's say, auto-matching what auto-outputs any incoming bank, uh, incoming payments from customers are, uh, happening.

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And there seems to be still one which is not being matched, even after I adjust, uh, my rule set.

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So I want to go and carry on and see what's—what's happening.

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I'm learning how to read it.

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So I'm probably going to have to stick to example one, which is basically the most interesting one.

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So what I see here, uh, I need to adjust, right?

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Now, I need to find out where this issue is sitting and where it is coming from.

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Now, in this case, apparently, the fact that this \$2,000 in this case was not being paid is because there's a complaint that has been filed by my customer.

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I didn't see that coming in.

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It was just an email.

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It might just have happened, right?

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If I look at my own mailbox, if you look at your own mailbox, you might be like, "Wow, you're in an overflow." You don't really see.

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Imagine that a message, that complaint, which is coming in, is automatically picked up, automatically interpreted, using large language model.

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That's exactly what we're looking to have here.

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And then ask the system, let's say, at least for a proposal based on, let's say, past behavior, past, um, past behavior of that customer, the number of disputes we already had, let's say, whether it's actually a nice, let's say, normal customer or not, whether, let's say, um, there has been payment delays before, or whether he's constantly using

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complaints, uh, filing as a way to, you know, delay his or her payments, etc., etc., also linking in my internal policies on when I'm allowed to issue a credit note, and so on and so forth.

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All of that is running in the background.

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Hundreds of pages of rules and, and experiences, etc., etc., which I just plug into my process, which is not new, right?

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This is what we know.

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Um, and then from there, basically, get going.

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My credit note, sending the communication out, and fine.

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And this is typically where the reasoning stops.

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Because it's not really where it should stop.

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It's what is the cost of this complaint?

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Imagine that I was not causing it myself, that I've been engaging a third party, a subcontractor, which has delivered the wrong quality.

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And actually, immediately, came back to my supplier manager or to my procurement team or whatever you want to call it.

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It's basically it's not my issue.

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Well, it is my issue.

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It is I'm I didn't cause the problem.

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The problem was caused by my supplier.

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So I am getting a complaint.

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I have a cash shortage.

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I basically need to get that prependant back.

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"Oh, I thought it's okay.

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It's obviously wrong." Very good.

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I feel at ease.

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So what we're doing now is basically we hand this over to the supplier manager.

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But how did this work?

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Actually, I was running through a little bit too fast.

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Is this is really the crux of the whole thing?

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This whole linkage of the fact that I understand exactly what business process and exactly all of the contextual information, not only the hard financial figures, that's really interesting.

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Imagine, yeah, that you every time you start analyzing, there are complete complaints.

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You basically put it to use in the transactional.

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You know where, let's say, a quality issue was coming up, etc., etc., etc.

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Imagine that here on the right-hand side, there's an agent which is doing this all for me in the background.

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And like we find these people saying, "Ah, yeah, that might be true.

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That might be possible." But I still want to understand what actually happens, what information I base myself on, uh, like, what the conclusion should be, etc., etc., and who do you involve?

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Like the AI, the second time I mentioned, is, is often seen as a black box.

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It's not.

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It doesn't have to be a black box.

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Here, I can really pick up all the documentation, all of the transactional information, all of the contextual information, all of the transactions, all of the steps in my process which I've been going through, and which AI capability which is built into the system has been addressing the lookup for this or that and so on and so on

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and so on.

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And basically, this is all listed here at the right-hand side.

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I just click, and I can open this up, which I'm not going to do right now because, like, that would be just too hard.

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But as a consequence, basically, I type back a little bit.

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I'm going to hand this over just like before to my supplier manager because that's where the real issue was, my issue.

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So jumping into that third persona, of course, again, nice dashboard.

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Nothing is so-so, so fancy special.

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Same thing.

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I'm getting, in other words, all my screens.

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I'm logging onto the system.

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Um, my little digital assistant is helping me, again, guiding me to where the relevant information is sitting, opening my supplier complaints, the complaint that I sent out to my supplier, not the one that I'm getting from my receiver, but from my from, uh, from my from my customer on the receivables side.

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And then basically getting all of the details from this because I still need to understand what I should do.

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And in this case, so I'm on the supplier side.

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It's actually a couple of, you know, colors or themes down the road.

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What I'm seeing here is I get a 360 view on my supplier situation in the state of myself.

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It seems to say they have been underperforming for a while.

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Of course, then you could say, "Well, no.

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The supplier manager should have been doing this for her job better already before." Might very well be, but it might not always be that obvious, right?

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So and then you might not just, you know, you might not get into that.

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You might not know.

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You might not see.

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So what am I going to do next?

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Well, there's different options.

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And as a supplier manager, I know one of the options might be, "Well, I want to create a new sourcing agent because these guys, I don't want to work with anymore.

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They're constantly causing issues, or they might be causing more and more issues in the future." That's not what I want to do.

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I don't want to keep on doing that firefighting.

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I want to think about this in a more strategic way.

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So I'm creating a sourcing agent.

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By the way, for your information, in the meantime, I switched between S4HANA, cash management, bank communication management.

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I was plugging in some AI capabilities.

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I'm looking to enter by service management.

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I've created my past crypto, and now I ended up in Alibaba.

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So I've been looking through a lot of different flows.

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But you can see me jumping around between users and systems, etc., etc.

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And it's not because of the nice video that I put together.

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This is really where we are heading towards.

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This is really having to take place as a central user experience, etc., etc.

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This is not working anymore.

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And then basically from here, I can go into this sourcing agent.

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Now, that would be basically procurement.

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So I'm sending over to my colleagues here in order to make this happen.

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Now, what did we look at from an architecture perspective?

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Because that's, of course, the answer that you're expecting here too.

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I know we are at the end, but so I already mentioned that we were running through different applications as 30 seconds.

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Um, that's basically the bottom part.

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That's where the magic really comes in is by connecting everything together.

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That's what we do in the data layer and there in the dark blue box with all kinds of technical capabilities.

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And then we are using Joel as a front end to really connect it also from a user experience.

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So that's hopefully interesting and showcasing where we are heading towards because it was not 100% there yet.

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All of the functionality is part of the visual integration and logic.

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It is already there.

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Part of it is basically still coming later on this year.

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Um, we've been running and rushing through, let's say, a first scenario.

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I have one on trade compliance as well.

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I can basically show you that outside of the labor.

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Uh, 30 minutes are a much faster than I had expected.

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Um, but hopefully, this was interesting to really get a feel from where we're heading where we are heading towards instead of all of the nice, you know, um, bullshitting words on AI using the bottom compliance.

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So thank you very much.

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And open for questions, um, outside, I guess, if you're going to want to necessarily be a fire agent already from the start of the day.

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Thank you.